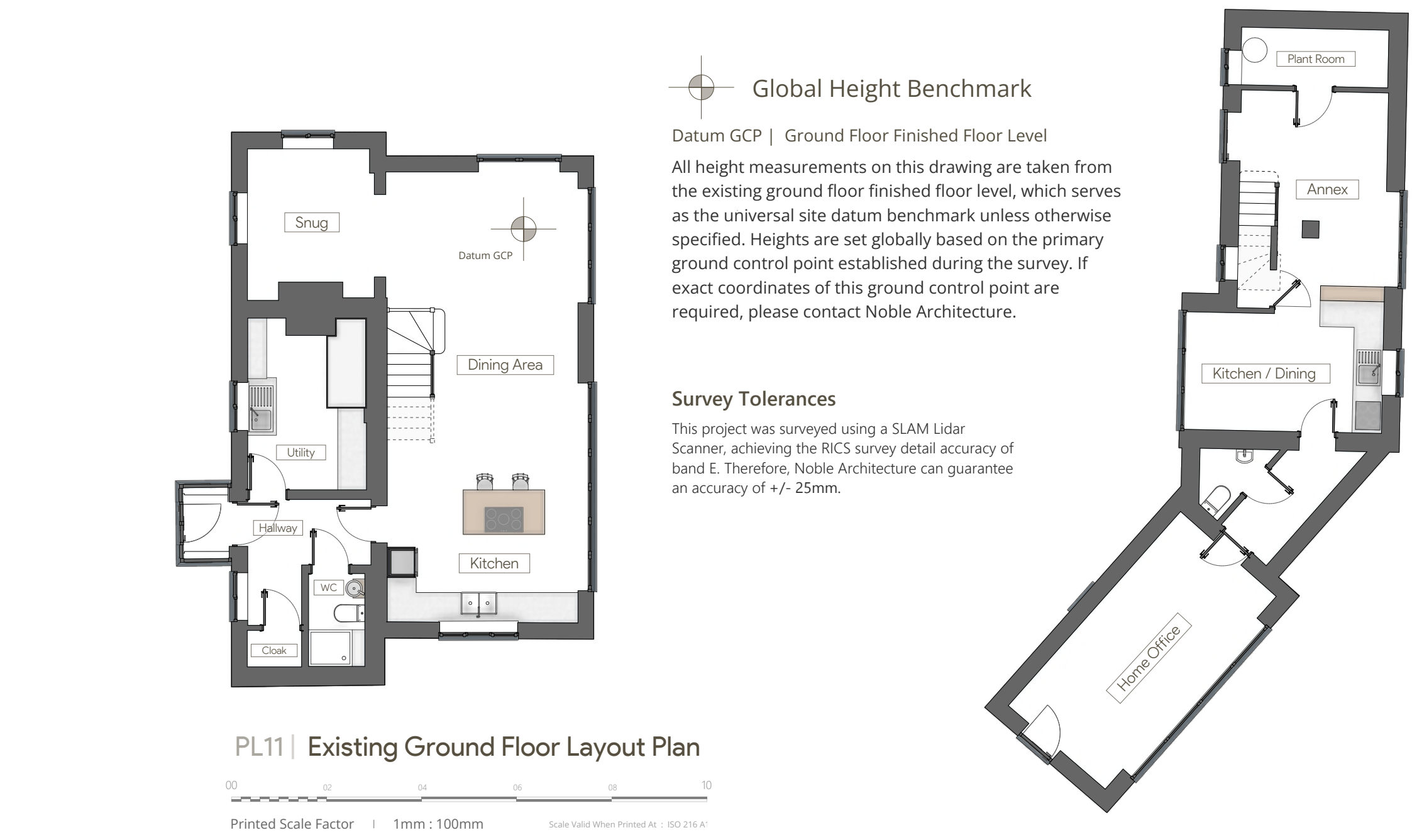
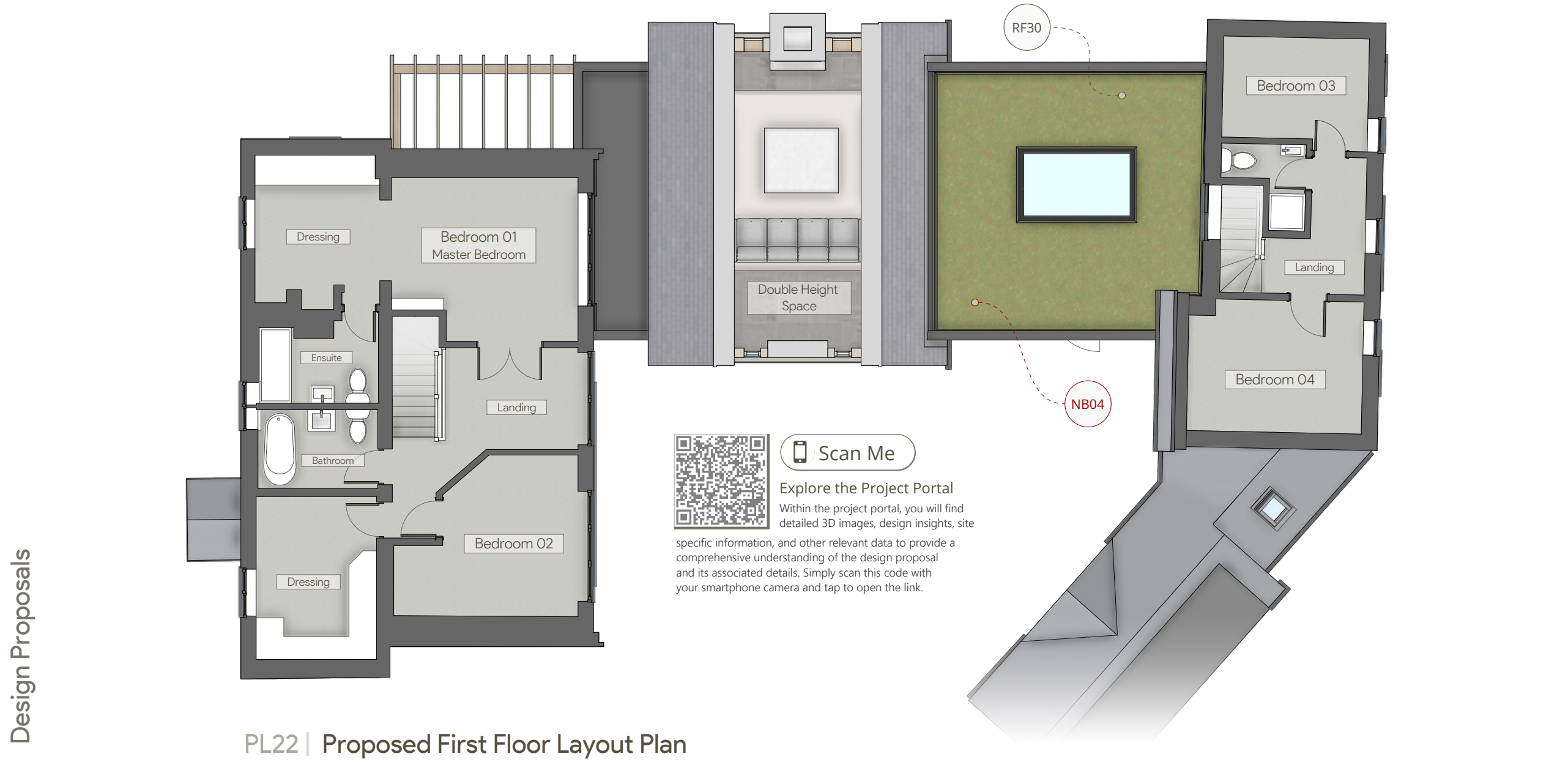
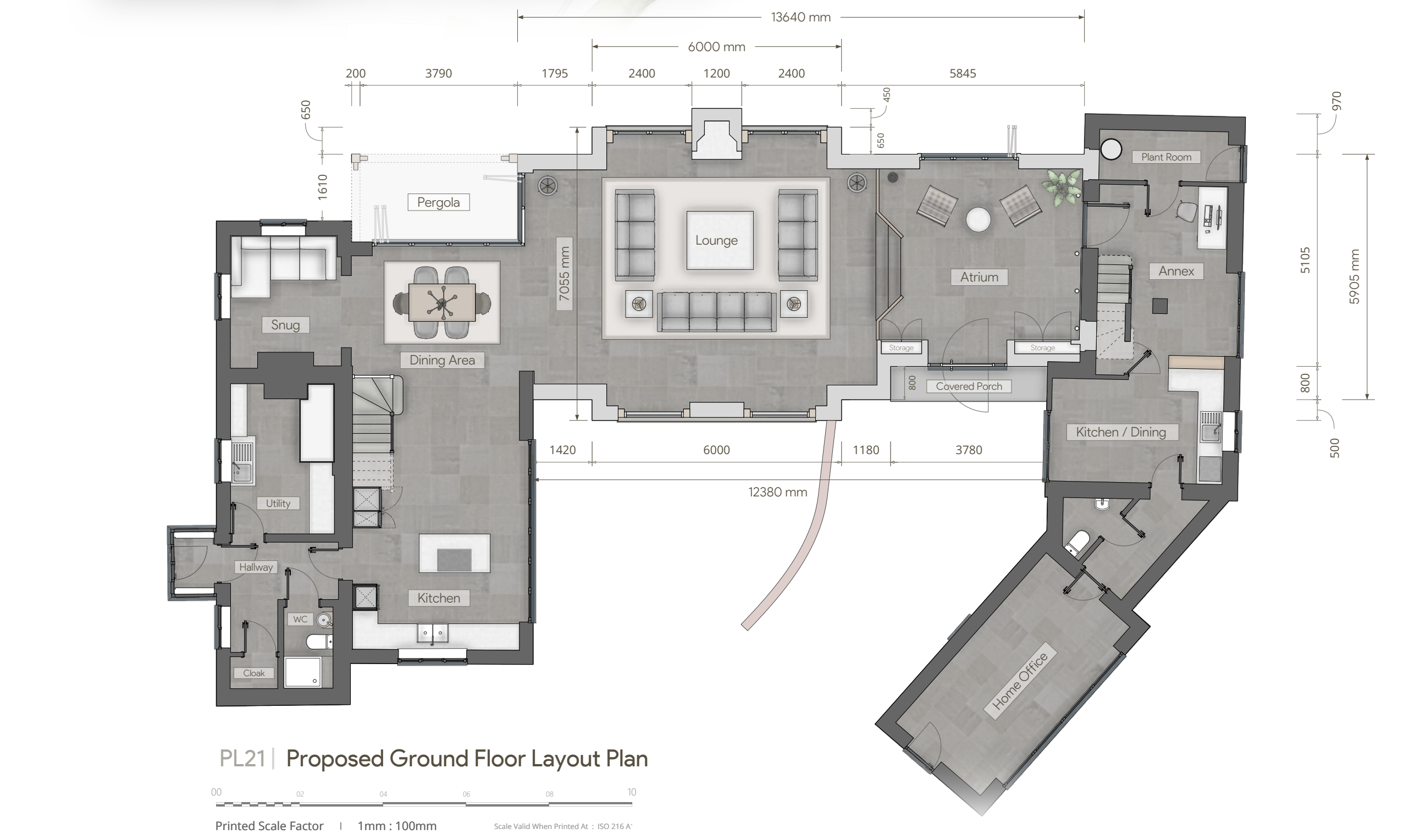
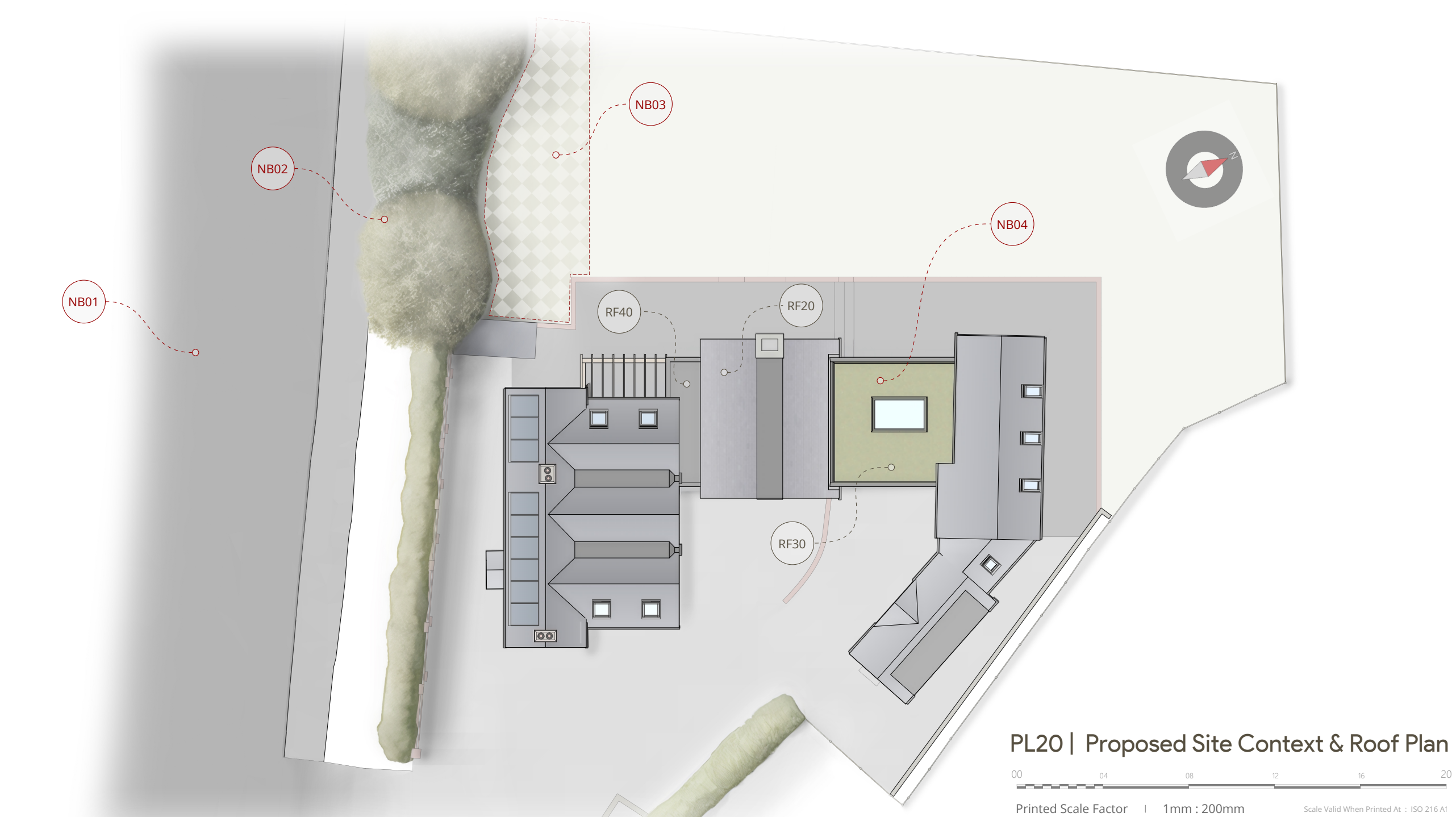




Existing Conditions



Design Proposals

Documents Referenced When Researching

- Stafford Borough Local Plan (2011-2031) | The Plan for Stafford Borough
- Design Supplementary Planning Document (SPD)

Policy N1 | Design

Emphasises the importance of high-quality design that respects the character and appearance of the surrounding area.

Relevant Context | Our selection of materials and finishes, such as weathered red brickwork and traditional slate roofing, ensures the extension harmonises with the existing structure and the local architectural vernacular, maintaining the area's character. By incorporating natural oak elements and carefully matching the existing materials, the design integrates seamlessly with the rural setting.

NB01 | The topographic height difference of the A51 means the extension will naturally appear less imposing from street level, reducing its visual impact and ensuring the design fits sensitively within the existing context.

Sustainability and Energy Efficiency

Policy N2 | Climate Change

Encourages measures that reduce energy consumption and promote sustainability in building design.

Relevant Context | The use of high-performance double or triple glazing with low-E argon-filled units in windows and doors enhances thermal efficiency, reducing energy consumption and contributing to a sustainable development. Additionally, the selection of durable, low-maintenance composite materials reduces the long-term environmental impact.

Biodiversity and Environmental Enhancement

Policy N4 | Natural Environment and Green Infrastructure

Supports initiatives to enhance biodiversity and improve green infrastructure.

Relevant Context | Our proposal includes increasing planting density in **Area NB03**, using a diverse range of plant species to create habitats for local wildlife. This contributes to the site's ecological value by providing nesting opportunities for birds and insects.

NB03 | The proposal focuses on improving the area adjacent to the boundary along the road. A new buffer zone will be created, transforming poorly draining ground into a naturally draining habitat. This aims to reduce flooding risks and help dissipate surface runoff effectively.

NB04 | The proposed flat roof will be constructed as a biodiverse green roof, planted with endemic Staffordshire wildflowers and grasses. This provides a sustainable, low-maintenance surface that greatly reduces surface water run-off, helping to address localised drainage and flooding concerns. The planting will enhance ecological value by creating habitats for insects and birds, contributing positively to biodiversity while visually softening the development within its rural context.

Landscaping and Screening

Policy N8 | Landscape Character

Highlights the importance of maintaining and enhancing local landscape character, particularly through effective planting and screening.

Relevant Context | The proposed natural sandstone patio and the use of natural materials like oak and slate ensure the development complements the existing landscape, preserving and enhancing the site's natural character. By retaining and enhancing the existing hedge along the A51 (**NB02**), we ensure the extension remains discreet and visually unobtrusive from public viewpoints.

NB02 | The established hedge along the A51 provides significant visual screening and will be further supplemented with additional planting, enhancing the natural boundary and softening the development's appearance.

Supplementary Planning Documents (SPDs)

Design SPD | Stafford Borough Council

Encourages careful consideration of materials, finishes, and detailing to ensure new developments are in harmony with their surroundings.

Relevant Context | The careful selection of materials, such as matching brickwork and traditional slate tiles, aligns with the Design SPD's emphasis on respecting local architectural styles and ensuring visual continuity with the existing building. The use of natural stone for the feature chimney further reinforces the high-quality design while creating a key focal point.

Application-Specific Notes

Visual Impact

Policy Compliance | Our commitment to maintaining and enhancing natural screening addresses concerns under Policy N8 and the Design SPD, ensuring the extension does not negatively impact the local landscape. The topographic difference of the A51 (**NB01**) further minimises the visual prominence of the extension from street level.

Environmental Enhancements

Policy Compliance | Biodiversity improvements, particularly in **NB03**, align with Policies N2 and N4, demonstrating our commitment to sustainable development and ecological enhancement.

Landscape Integration

Policy Compliance | The design's consideration of local landscape character, enhanced by material selection and strategic planting, ensures the extension integrates seamlessly with its surroundings, supporting Policy N8 and the Design SPD.

Design Impact Summary

Our proposal reflects Stafford Borough Council's planning priorities by adhering to design, sustainability, and landscape policies. By addressing key site characteristics such as the topographic height difference (**NB01**), retaining and enhancing existing foliage (**NB02**), and improving biodiversity (**NB03**), the design ensures a cohesive, environmentally responsible, and aesthetically pleasing & context sensitive home extension.